

Jothi Teaching Standards

ASSESSMENT AND PROGRESS MONITORING STANDARD

Operational standard for using assessment to reveal understanding, guide teaching, and monitor academic progress

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Intended Audience	Tutors, mentors, and academy leadership
Related Documents	JF03 v2.0, JTS01 v2.0, JTS04 v2.0, JTD01 v2.0, JTD02 v2.0, JTD04 v2.0

1. Purpose

Assessment at Johti is part of teaching — not separate from it. This standard defines how tutors use different types of assessment to reveal student thinking, identify misconceptions, and make informed teaching decisions. Assessment that produces a mark without changing teaching has no developmental value.

Linked competencies: D1 (Using Assessment to Diagnose Understanding), D2 (Tracking Student Progress Over Time), D3 (Planning Interventions Based on Evidence), D4 (Supporting Examination Readiness).

2. Types of Assessment

Type	When Used	What It Provides
Diagnostic questioning	Throughout every lesson	Immediate evidence of whether explanation has produced understanding. The most frequent and most important form of assessment. Covered in JTS01 v2.0 and linked to C2, C3. (D1)
Short lesson task	During or at the end of the lesson	Checks whether the student can apply the concept independently or semi-independently. Reveals whether understanding is procedural (copying method) or conceptual (understanding why). (D1)

Type	When Used	What It Provides
Topic test	After a block of learning	Checks whether understanding has consolidated across a topic — not just the last example taught. Reveals whether the student can handle variation in the question. (D1, D2)
Cumulative assessment	Periodically across lessons	Revisits earlier content to check whether understanding has been retained. Students may appear secure immediately after teaching while forgetting the same content weeks later. (D2)
Exam-style assessment	When preparing for school or public assessments	Develops written precision, question interpretation, time discipline, and structured method. Must sit on top of real understanding — not substitute for it. (D4)

3. What Tutors Look For in Assessment

A mark tells you whether the student got it right. That is not enough. The tutor's job is to read what the assessment reveals about the student's thinking.

When reviewing assessment, the tutor should ask:

- Can the student explain the method — or are they reproducing a memorised procedure?
- Are errors random (attentional slips) or patterned (conceptual gaps)?
- Can the student transfer the understanding to a question that varies slightly from the one taught?
- Does the student's confidence match their actual performance?
- Is the misunderstanding conceptual, procedural, or attentional?

Mastery threshold

A student is ready to move forward when they can apply the concept independently, explain the reasoning, complete related questions without heavy prompting, and handle variation in the task. One correct answer in ideal conditions is not mastery.

4. Using Assessment Evidence to Drive Teaching

Assessment is only valuable if it changes what happens next. The decision tree below defines what each evidence type should trigger.

Assessment Reveals...	Teaching Response
Secure understanding across the topic	Progress to the next concept. Introduce appropriate challenge. Note readiness in the lesson record.
Correct answers but no ability to explain	Do not progress. The understanding is procedural, not conceptual. Slow down. Ask why questions before moving on.

Assessment Reveals...	Teaching Response
Patterned errors pointing to a specific misconception	Stop and address the misconception directly. Reteach the affected concept. Do not continue building on a broken foundation. (D3)
Inconsistent performance — right sometimes, wrong sometimes	Do not assume the correct answers show understanding. More diagnostic questioning is needed to establish what is actually secure. (D1)
Weak performance across a topic block	Review what was taught. Consider whether the explanation, sequencing, or pacing was the issue. Reteach with a different approach. (D3, B1, B2)
Forgotten content from previous lessons	Build in retrieval practice. Space revisiting of earlier material. Progress is not durable if earlier content is not retained. (D2)

5. Progress Monitoring Over Time

Progress is not the accumulation of completed topics. It is the growth of reliable, transferable understanding. Tutors should maintain a picture of each student's development across lessons — not just within them.

- Track which topics are secure, which are fragile, and which are not yet taught.
- Notice recurring misconceptions — the same error appearing across different topics usually points to a foundational gap.
- Track improvement in reasoning quality, not just marks.
- Note when a student's confidence begins to outpace or fall behind their actual performance.
- Identify when earlier content appears to be weakening — secure understanding can degrade without reinforcement.

This tracking picture is what makes parent communication meaningful (JTS04) and what informs intervention decisions (D3). Without it, both are based on guesswork.

6. Feedback to Students

Assessment should always lead to feedback. Effective feedback does three things:

- Identifies what is correct and why it is correct — not just that it is right.
- Identifies what is wrong, explains the error clearly, and rebuilds the understanding.
- Makes the next step for improvement clear and actionable.

'Nearly there' and 'check your working' are not feedback. They leave the student with no clearer picture of what to do differently. Feedback is specific or it is useless.

7. Common Assessment Errors

Error	Why It Matters
Treating marks as the primary outcome	Marks tell you the score. They do not tell you what the student understands or why they got it wrong. Teaching should respond to understanding, not to scores.
Moving on after a correct answer	A correct answer may reflect procedure, guessing, or luck. The reasoning behind it must be checked before assuming understanding is secure.
Relying on one type of assessment	Diagnostic questioning in lessons, topic tests, and cumulative checks serve different purposes. Using only one leaves blind spots.
Assessing content that was not taught	Tests must connect to what has been taught. Assessing unfamiliar content produces misleading results and undermines student confidence.
Recording performance without acting on it	A mark logged and ignored is administrative overhead. Assessment data only matters when it changes what the tutor does next.
Assuming recent success means durable understanding	Students often perform well immediately after teaching and forget within days. Cumulative assessment exists to detect this.

8. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Assessment types presented as a table with competency codes	v1.0 described each type in separate prose sections. The table gives a faster reference and links each type to D-domain competency codes.
Decision table for assessment-to-teaching response added	New in v2.0. v1.0 stated that assessment should change teaching without specifying what changes to make in response to different evidence types.
Mastery threshold defined explicitly	v1.0 referred to mastery without defining it. v2.0 names the four conditions that indicate readiness to progress.
Full 4T model description removed	v1.0 restated the 4T model in the context of assessment. v2.0 references JF03 v2.0 and focuses on assessment-specific guidance.
Feedback section tightened	v1.0 described feedback across multiple paragraphs. v2.0 reduces it to three clear requirements and a direct statement about what does not count as feedback.

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